SPIN® 3.0

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Use SPIN Questions

PROBLEM

- "How concerned are you about ...?"
- "Does it worry you that ...?"
- "How difficult do you find it to ...?"
- "Is there a risk of ...?"
- "What sort of problems do you get with ...?"
- "How satisfied are you with ...?"
- "Are you satisfied with the level of ...?"
- "Is it hard to cope with ...?"
- "How well are you able to cope with ...?"
- "What sort of dissatisfaction do you have with ...?"
- "How worried are you with such a high level of ...?"
- "Can your current equipment deal with all the functions that you need?"
- "When does X reach intolerable levels?"
- "Other clients tell me X is a problem—do you find that?"

IMPLICATION

- "How often do you find X results in problems with Y?"
- "What are the difficulties faced when ...?"
- "Do you also find that can affect X?"
- "What effect does that have on X?"
- "When that happens, what other difficulties are caused by X?"
- "What sort of consequences does that lead to?"
- "What are the related effects on X?"
- "What implications does that have for X?"
- "You say you have problems with X. How does that impact Y?"
- "Am I right that when X occurs, it sometimes results in Y?"
- "Does that also impact ...?"
- "What ramification does that have for ...?"
- "What happens when ...?"
- "Who else suffers when ...?"

NEED-PAYOFF

Identify

- "Are you saying it would help if we could ...?"
- "Are you looking for a way of ...?"
- "Would you be interested in X?"
- "Would you like to be able to ...?"

Clarify

- "Why is X so important to you?"
- "What sort of savings would X produce?"
- "What do you regard as the main benefits of X?"
- "How important is it for you to improve X?"

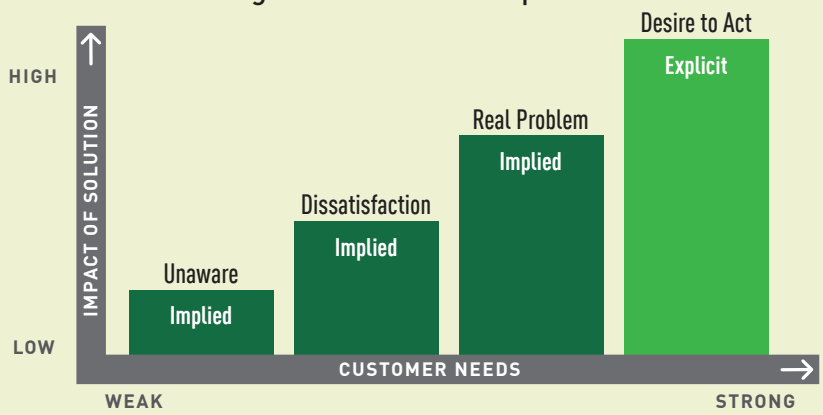
Extend

- "How else could X be beneficial to your division?"
- "What other ways could X help you?"
- "In what other ways could X improve your process?"

Listen for Customer Needs

IMPLIED NEEDS	EXPLICIT NEEDS
Severity	Need
Concern	Want
Problem	Certain
Challenge	Must
Issues	Have to
Bothered	Should
Stressful	Would
Tough	Got to
Cumbersome	Love

Stages of Needs Development



Validate Criteria for Intent to Act

Has the customer expressed:

- ☐ The full extent of the problem
- ☐ Implications of not acting
- ☐ A sense of urgency to address the issue
- ☐ The payoffs of addressing the issue
- ☐ A vision for a potential solution

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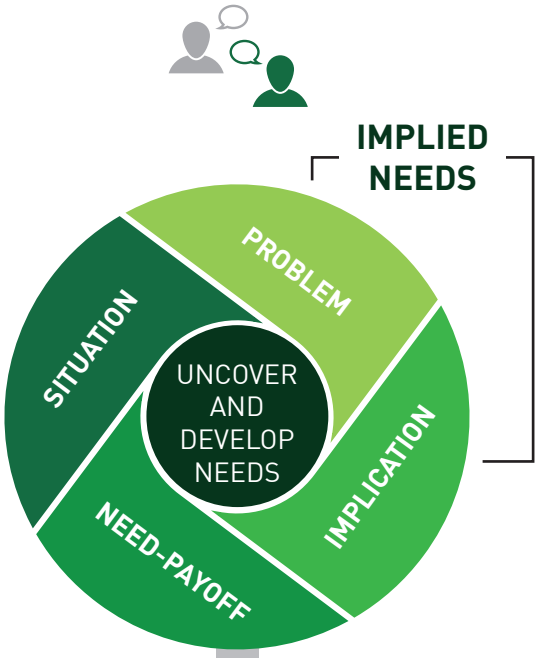
OPENING

INVESTIGATING

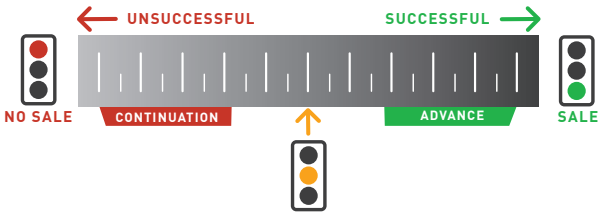


EXPLICIT NEEDS

DEMONSTRATING CAPABILITY

BENEFITS =
Customer Explicit Need
+ Your Capability

OBTAINING COMMITMENT



Definitions

Implied Needs
Customer statements of problems, difficulties, or dissatisfaction

Explicit Needs
Customer statements of strong wants or desires

Situation
About facts, background information

Problem
About problems, difficulties, or dissatisfaction

Implication
About the effects or consequences of problems

Need-Payoff
About the value and usefulness of a solution

Features
Facts, data, or information about the sellers' products or services
Impact on sale: neutral, creates price concerns

Advantages
Show how products or services can be used or help the customer
Impact on sale: slightly positive, creates objections

Benefits
Show how capabilities meet Explicit Need expressed by the customer
Impact on sale: very positive, creates agreement

Successful: Advance
The seller suggests an appropriate next step to move the sale forward and the customer commits to take action.

Unsuccessful: Continuation
The seller and customer may continue to meet, but the customer has not committed to take any action that moves the sale forward.

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